

Gentle Stoic Parenting

Our family *rhythm*

A morning & evening handbook for Juan and Christine



We don't need to be perfect. We need to be the same team every day.



Chapter 1

Hello, team!

Sophia · 7

Isaac · 5

Christine

Juan

These four numbers hold everything else together.

7:00

Sophia wakes

age 7 · her kitchen time

7:25

Isaac wakes

age 5 · both grown-ups
present

8:15

We leave

Real limit 8:25 · school
8:45

8:30

Asleep

Slow rhythm from 7:30

The school run is 20 minutes and the goal is 8:45, so the real limit is 8:25. The family leaves at 8:15: those ten minutes are a cushion. If all goes well, they're spare. If something goes wrong, the surprise eats them and you still arrive on time. Sophia wakes earlier because Isaac needs more sleep; both go to bed at the same time, equally tired.

One plan

It's the same for both of you. When in doubt, this book wins, not whoever has more energy right then.

Read it together once

After that, use it as a quick check for your part of the day.

A two-week trial

Follow it as written before changing anything. Habits need time.

Adjust as a team

Changes are decided at 8:30, never in front of
2 the kids.



Chapter 2

Our week

Each morning one grown-up does the school run and one stays home. At night the roles cross over, so nobody carries everything.

Drop-off parent

in the morning

Showers 7:00–7:25 while the other parent cooks with Sophia. At 7:25 wakes Isaac and helps him get ready. Teeth, shoes, backpacks. Drives the kids to school.

in the evening

In the evening, owns dinner: cooking, the 7:40 bridge snack, closing the kitchen and packing tomorrow's backpacks.

Home parent

in the morning

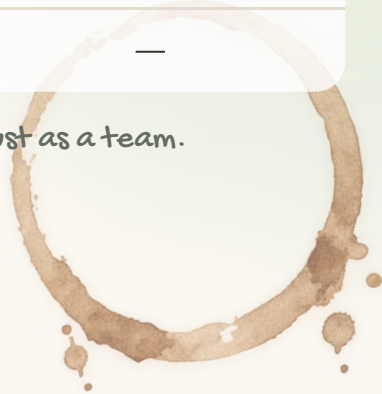
Wakes Sophia at 7:00 and cooks the menu breakfast with her. Wipes the table. When the others leave at 8:15, showers and has their own time.

in the evening

In the evening, owns bath & stories: play while dinner cooks, bath, pajamas, teeth, stories and lights out.

DAY	DROP-OFF	HOME	DINNER	BATH & STORIES	BREAKFAST	AFTERNOON
Monday	Juan	Christine	Juan	Christine	Oatmeal with fruit & honey	Judo 6:30 · ballet 7:00
Tuesday	Christine	Juan	Christine	Juan	Scrambled eggs	—
Wednesday	Juan	Christine	Juan	Christine	Yogurt with granola & fruit	Ballet 7:00
Thursday	Christine	Juan	Christine	Juan	Toast with avocado or cheese	—
Friday	Juan	Christine	Juan	Christine	Pancakes	—

* The evening crossover is a proposal: try it for two weeks and adjust as a team.



Team rules

Six small agreements that keep the plan the same, whether it comes from mum or dad.

Whoever leads, leads

Today's role decides how its part is done. The other parent doesn't correct in front of the kids. Concerns wait until 8:30.

Tidy first, then we move on

Nobody moves to the next step until their own things are put away: plate, pajamas, toys. Grown-ups too.

Five team minutes

At 8:30, kids asleep: what worked? what do we adjust tomorrow? No blame.

At 7:25 we're both there

No exceptions, all five days. The same support on Juan's days and on Christine's.

Dinner is sacred

No screens, no work and no cleaning while we eat. All four at the table.

The tag-out word

If one of us loses patience, they say "tag" and the other steps in, no comments.

«*Tidy first, then we move on.*»



The morning I

Mornings are only for what the kids already know how to do. New skills get practised at the weekend.



6:55

Grown-ups get up

BOTH

A few minutes before the kids: water, a breath, coffee. A calm grown-up is the first step of a calm morning.

7:00

Sophia wakes up

HOME

Wakes Sophia softly and opens the curtains.

DROP-OFF

Showers until 7:25.

SOPHIA

Gets dressed first.

Say: "Good morning. The kitchen is waiting for us."

7:10

Sophia's kitchen time

HOME

Cooks the menu breakfast with her. Minds the stove and reminds her which parts are hot.

SOPHIA

Whisks, serves and sets the table.

7:25

Isaac wakes · both grown-ups in

DROP-OFF

Freshly showered, wakes Isaac.

ISAAC

Picks the breakfast story or podcast. It's his job.

Say: "You get to pick the breakfast story today."



The morning II



7:30

Isaac gets ready

DROP-OFF Walks beside him, not for him: bathroom, clothes, bed made.

HOME Finishes breakfast with Sophia.

Say: “Your socks are waiting on the chair.”

If it stalls → Describe what you see instead of giving orders. Offer two choices: “shirt first or pants first?”

7:45

Family breakfast

EVERYONE All four at the table. Isaac's story is playing. No screens.

8:00

Tidy first

KIDS Each carries their plate and cup to the sink and puts pajamas in the hamper.

BOTH Grown-ups carry theirs too. Nobody tidies for someone else.

Say: “Your plate is still on the table. We move on once it's in the sink.”

8:05

Teeth, shoes, backpacks

DROP-OFF Teeth and shoes with the kids. Backpacks were packed last night.

HOME Wipes the table.

Say: “Our shoes are waiting by the door.”

8:15

Off we go!

DROP-OFF Drives the kids. If something went wrong, there's a ten-minute cushion until 8:25.

HOME Now it's their shower and their own time.



Chapter 5

The breakfast menu

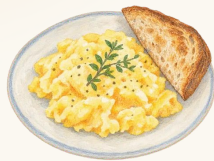
One set breakfast per day. Sophia only cooks: she doesn't have to decide. Choosing and cooking at 7 a.m. is too much at once.



Monday

Oatmeal with fruit & honey

Sophia adds fruit and honey. The grown-up heats the oats.



Tuesday

Scrambled eggs

Her specialty: she cracks and whisks. The grown-up minds the pan.



Wednesday

Yogurt with granola & fruit

No stove. A light day before ballet.



Thursday

Toast with avocado or cheese

Sophia spreads and serves. The grown-up runs the toaster.



Friday

Pancakes

Friday treat. Sophia mixes and serves; the grown-up flips.



Plan B · cereal with milk and a banana

Always in the pantry, ready in five minutes. Not a failure: it's the safety net.

Sophia in the kitchen, step by step

Her job is the food, never Isaac: she doesn't check or correct him. If something burns, no scolding and no rescue: Plan B, and she tries again tomorrow.

Step 1 · now

Together

Sophia cracks, whisks, serves and sets the table. The grown-up handles the stove.

Step 2

She cooks, grown-up beside her

Sophia stirs the pan. The grown-up is an arm's length away and says little.

Step 3

On her own

The grown-up is home but not in the kitchen. Only once step 2 comes easily on weekdays.

The calm evening I

In the evening the roles cross over: whoever did the school run makes dinner; whoever stayed home does bath & stories.



6:00

Dinner gets made

DINNER Cooks. The kids help if they want to.

BATH & STORIES Play and connection with the kids. No work, no chores.

6:30

Family dinner · 30 minutes

EVERYONE Seated together, no screens. With a screen in front of them, kids watch and don't eat.

If it stalls → If they haven't finished by 7:00, calmly clear the plate. That's what the 7:40 snack is for.

7:00

Everything goes home

EVERYONE Everyone carries their plate. Five minutes for toys to go back to their baskets, grown-ups helping.

Say: "The blocks want to go to sleep in their basket."

7:10

Bath

BATH & STORIES Kids' bath.

DINNER Closes the kitchen and leaves backpacks by the door.



The calm evening II

From 7:30 everything slows down: low lights, soft voices, few words.



7:30

The slow rhythm begins

EVERYONE

Low lights, slow voices, few words. Pajamas. Dirty clothes in the hamper.

7:40

The last snack of the day

DINNER

Offers the bridge snack: fruit, bread or milk.

BATH & STORIES

Teeth right after.

Say: *"This is the last food for today. Does your tummy want something?"*

7:50

Tomorrow's clothes

KIDS

Each child lays tomorrow's clothes on the chair.

7:55

Stories

BATH & STORIES

Each child in their own bed. The grown-up sits in between and reads one book each child chose.

DINNER

Free time for themselves.

8:15

Lights out

BATH & STORIES

Turns off the light. The same closing words and three breaths together.

Say: *"The day is done. Your body can rest now."*

8:30

Asleep · five team minutes

BOTH

What worked today? What do we adjust tomorrow?



Monday & Wednesday

Isaac is home from judo at 6:30 on Mondays and Sophia is home from ballet at 7:00 on Mondays and Wednesdays.

Bedtime doesn't move: we cut steps, not sleep. Dinner is made ahead of time.

4:30

A proper snack

EVERYONE

Whoever picks them up gives a real snack before the activity.

6:30

Isaac: bath and pajamas

BATH & STORIES

Monday: Isaac comes home from judo, straight to the bath.

Wednesday: bath at the same time.

DINNER

Warms up the dinner prepared in advance.

7:00

Sophia home from ballet

7:05

Family dinner · 25 minutes

EVERYONE

Together, no screens. Then everyone carries their plate.

7:30

Shower and teeth

BATH & STORIES

Quick shower for Sophia.

DINNER

Isaac's teeth.

7:45

Almost there

KIDS

Sophia's teeth, tomorrow's clothes on the chair, toys in the basket.

7:55

One shared story

8:15

Lights out · asleep by 8:30 ₁₀



When things go off plan



Always the same order: the grown-up breathes first, then observes, then asks one question. The parent on duty responds; the other supports quietly.

"I'm hungry" after teeth

1. The 7:40 snack was the last food.
2. Offer water. Nothing else.
3. Tomorrow, review dinner in the team minutes.

Say: *"Your tummy is asking. Tomorrow's breakfast will be waiting for it. Would you like water?"*

Gets out of bed

1. Walk them back with few words, the same every time, without anger.
2. If it keeps happening, talk about it in the daytime, through a story.

Say: *"The light is off and your body is still awake. Let's go back to your bed."*

Sibling fight or drama

1. The grown-up breathes first.
2. Separate if needed, without looking for blame.
3. One question each, taking turns. No lecture.

Say: *"I see two very upset kids. What do you need right now?"*

The morning runs late

1. The ten-minute cushion is there for this.
2. Cut something, never shout: the bed gets made in the afternoon.
3. If breakfast goes wrong: Plan B.

Say: *"The clock says it's shoe time."*

A plate stays on the table

1. Don't clear it for them.
2. Name what you see and wait calmly.

Say: *"Your plate is still here. We'll move on when it reaches the sink."*

A grown-up loses patience

1. Say "tag". The other takes over, no comments, no looks.
2. Talk at 8:30, calmly. It isn't failure: it's teamwork.

Chapter 9

Five team minutes

Every night at 8:30, kids asleep. Short, no blame, looking at tomorrow.

- ☐ What worked today?
- ☐ Where did we get stuck?
- ☐ What small tweak do we try tomorrow?
- ☐ Ready for tomorrow: backpacks, clothes, breakfast?

Still to decide

Weekends

The Saturday–Sunday rhythm and Sophia's cooking practice.

Off-plan protocol

The sister project, situation by situation.

Who sleeps where

Revisit once the routine is steady and the room is fixed.



The end

Life doesn't have to be hard.